

is physically unable to perform the fantastic shopping feats shown on this reality-based program that, in fact, doesn't resemble reality in the least.

I was approached by the *Extreme Couponing* team for the possibility of inclusion in their program on three separate occasions, and each time I reiterated that it was nearly impossible in Iowa to replicate the type of sprees they featured on their program. I got a peek into the “reality” of the program when I was asked this revealing question: “If we took you to a store that doubled coupons, or found a store that would allow it for the purpose of the program, would you be able to do it?” It was apparent that for an Iowan with no double coupon opportunities, producers of the program would have had to transport me out of state for filming, and traveling out of state to shop is hardly a reality for the average Iowan.



I've done the planned media shopping trips—saving free product coupons or arranging a shopping spree specifically around products that will cost just pennies after my coupons. I've seen the reporter and photographer share amused glances at my running commentary as we peruse store aisles together and their confusion over the items I'm choosing to put in my cart. Why would a frugal mother buy ten packages of paper plates? Wouldn't it make more financial sense to use regular plates and wash them? What about